

Brand Guidelines

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Logo

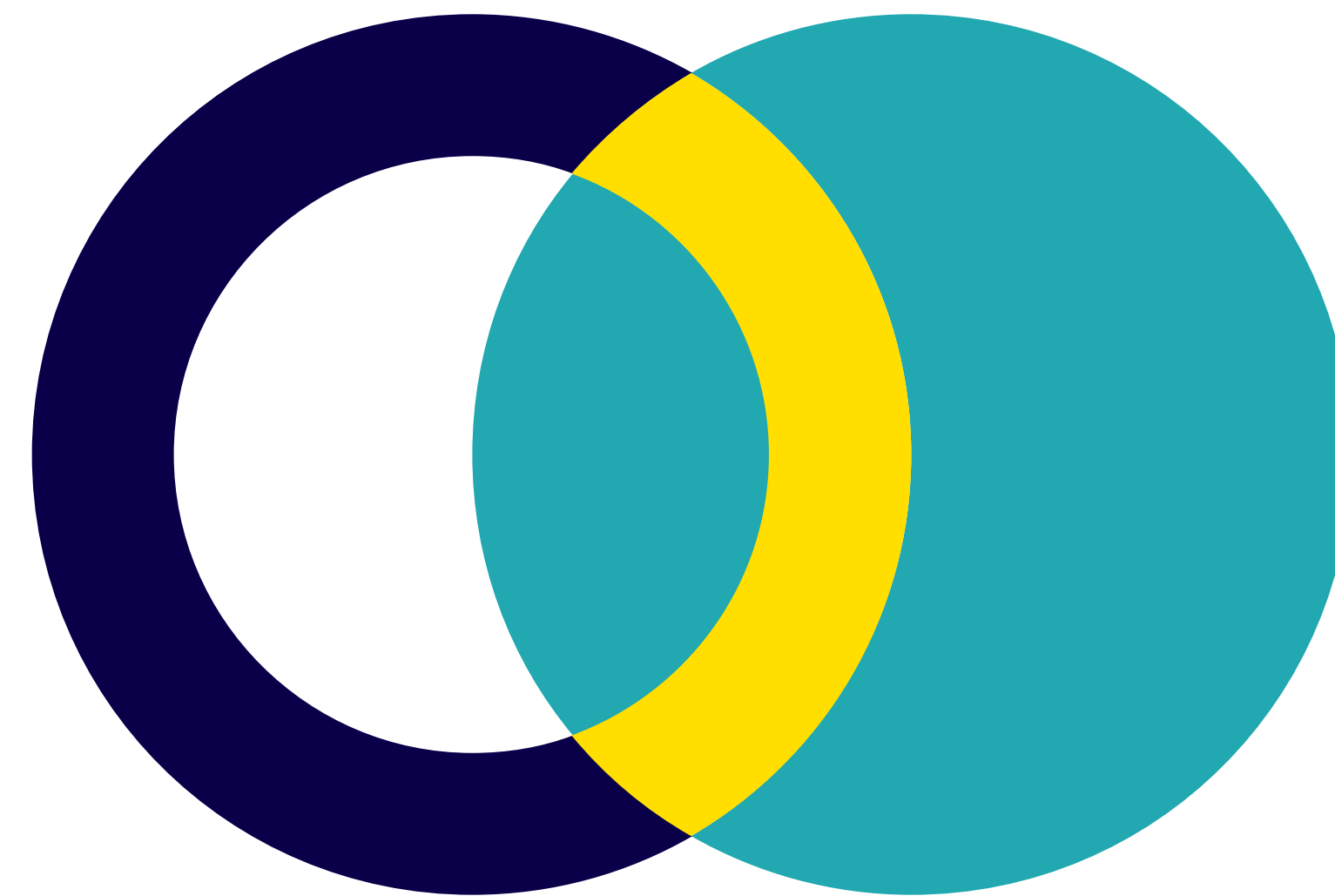
1

Logo Concept

A Venn diagram is an illustration that used circles to show the relationships among things or finite groups of things. Circles that overlap have a commonality while circles that do not overlap do not share those traits.

Venn diagrams help to visually represent the similarities and differences between two concepts.

Aptly's logo represent the bases of their values and purpose: highest quality course content meets excellent student service.



Logo Variants

Aptly's identity's main element is its logo. The logo consists of a wordmark and a logotype.

There is a vertical and horizontal option for each logo variation. We recommend using the vertical option for when the logo needs to be aligned centrally on a format; the horizontal – for when the logo needs to be aligned to the left or to the right.

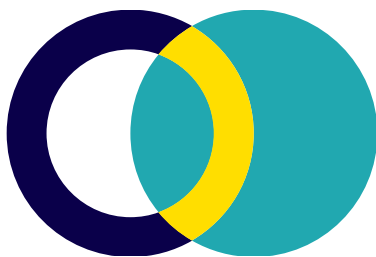
Horizontal



Vertical



Icon



Wordmark



Logo Usage

Aptly logo variations can be used on three backgrounds – Navy, Teal and White from Aptly color palette.

The colors of the inverted elements depend on the background, with the intersection always shown in Yellow.

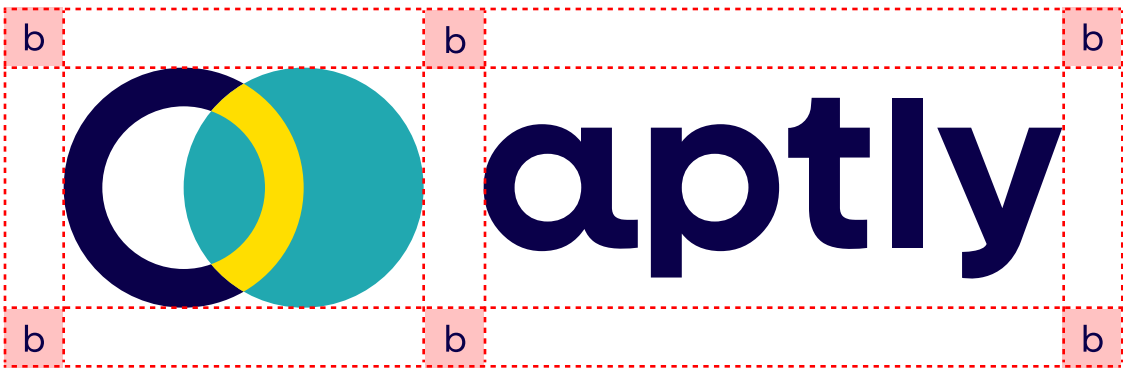
Logo can be used in black and white for example for B&W printings. However the logo can not be used in white or in any other stand-alone color. Use the provided monochrome logos that respect the brandbook.



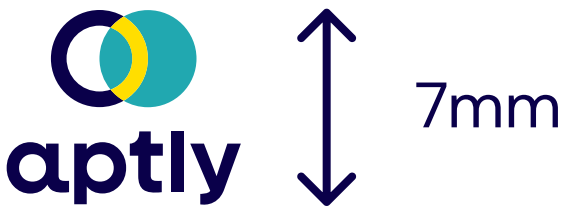
Logo Sizing

Readability is important: the minimum logo size for print is calculated so that the minimum logotype height is 7mm for vertical logo and 5mm for horizontal logo. The minimum logo height for web is 24px.

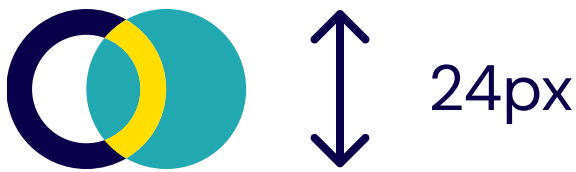
Clearspace



Minimum Size for Print



Minimum Size for Web

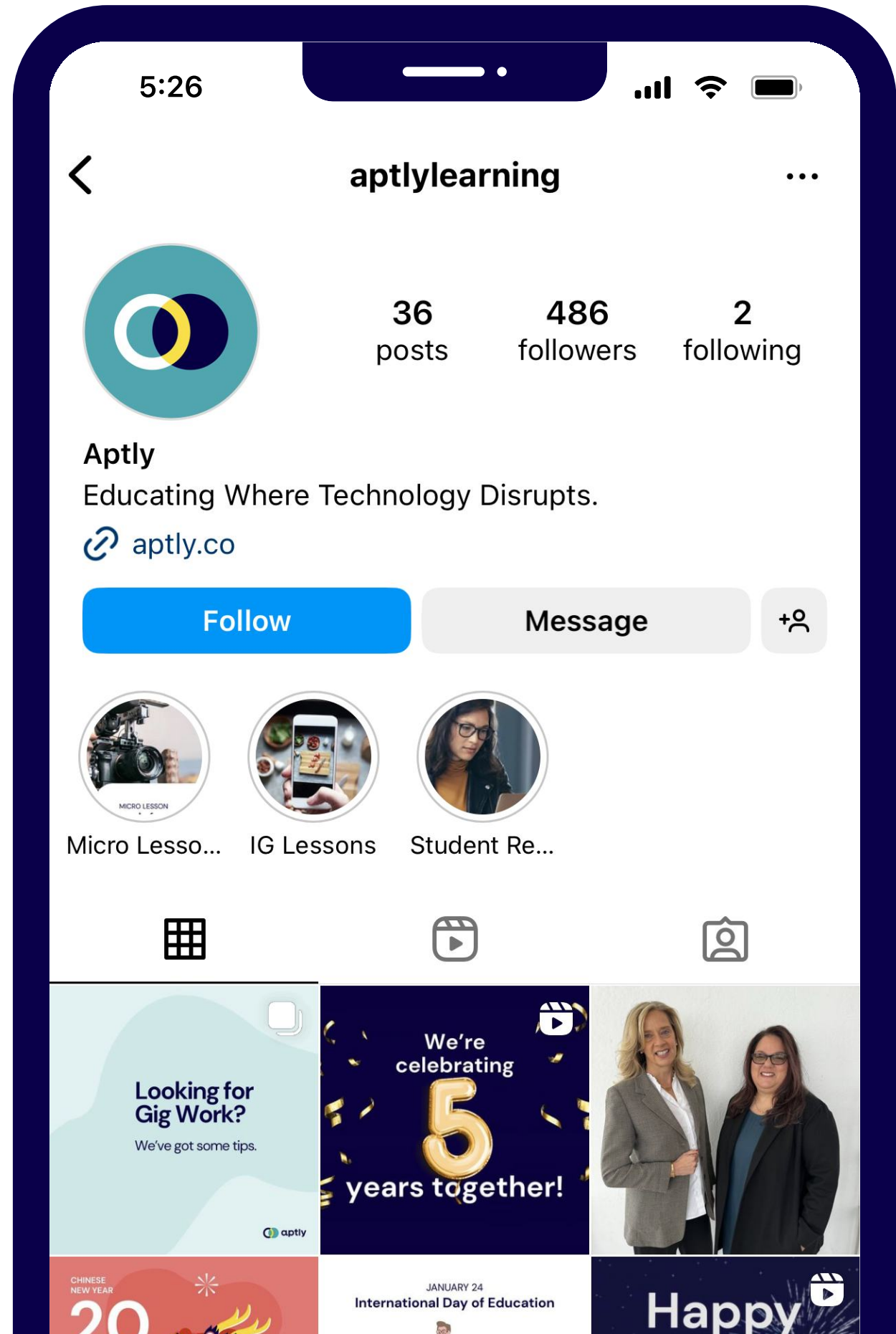


Icon

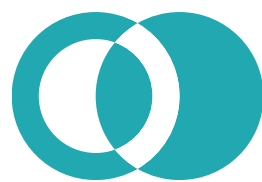
Icon version is used wherever long version would not be reconizable because of size or where icon version is visually more appealing.

The icon logo is designed with adaptability in mind, featuring three distinct color backgrounds to suit various presentation contexts. Each background color is carefully chosen to enhance the logo's visibility and appeal across different platforms and mediums.

Example: Social Media Profile Icons



Improper Logo Usage



Do not use the logo in stand-alone color



Do not rotate the logo



Do not change the proportions on the logo



Do not apply graphic effects on the logo



Do not change the colors on the logo



Do not change the font, font's kerning or font spacing of the logo



Do not use the logo on complex backgrounds



Do not change the opacity on the logo



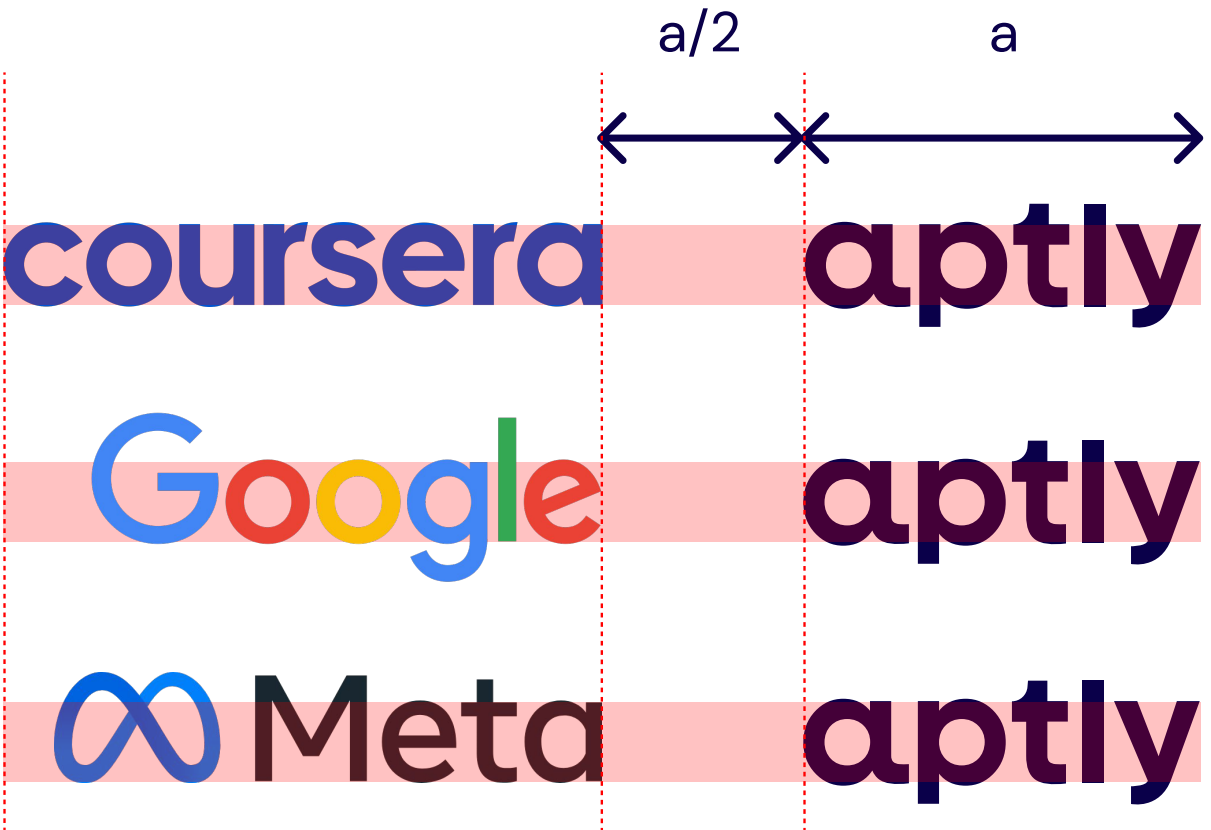
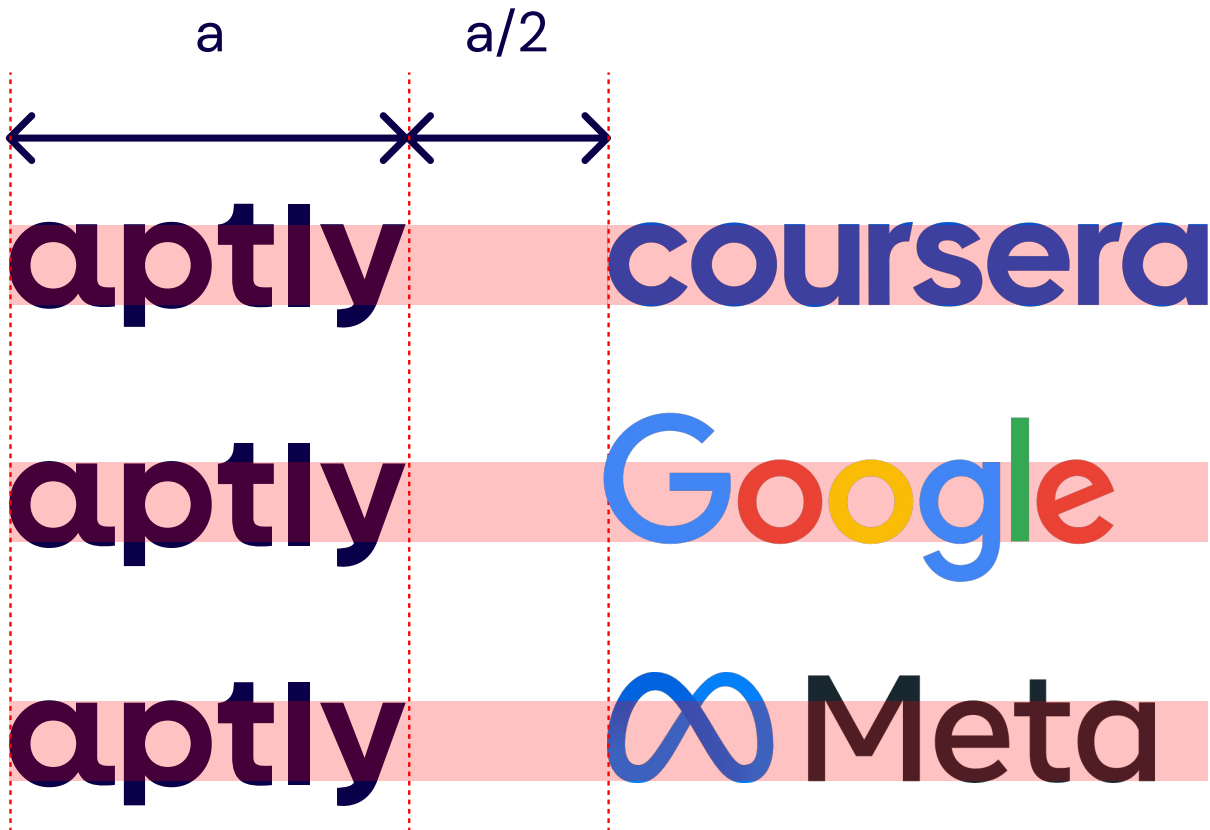
Do not shrink or deform the logo in any way



Logo Usage with Client Logos

Make use of Aptly's wordmark if you need to pair it with a Client's logo. The minimum space between Aptly's wordmark and the Client's logo equals the wordmark length, divided by 2.

Make sure that the height of Aptly's wordmark and the Client's logo are equal.



Typography 2

DM Sans

Google Typeface

DM Sans

Aptly uses DM Sans as the brand typeface. It is available in Google Fonts which allows all users to download and respect the brand’s visual identity.

DM Sans is a low-contrast geometric sans serif design, intended for use at smaller text sizes.

DM Sans supports a Latin Extended glyph set, enabling typesetting for English and other Western European languages. It was designed by Colophon Foundry (UK), who started from the Latin portion of Indian Type Foundry's Poppins.

In May 2023 DM Sans is updated, expanding the coverage of the weight range to Thin & ExtraBlack (100–1000 weight range) along with a new optical size axis.

Bold

Aa

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789!"#\$%&/()=

Medium

Aa

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789!"#\$%&/()=

Regular

Aa

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789!"#\$%&/()=

Text Hierarchy Example

Type hierarchy is crucial to the Aptly brand. This page acts as a reference for how to clearly scale and showcase hierarchy with Aptly brand typefaces.

About Aptly

Prepare for the jobs of tomorrow, today!

Aptly® designs and produces award-winning business education programs that help learners and businesses navigate digital disruption.

[View All Courses](#)

Color 3

Main Color Palette

Aptly’s primary palette consists of three colors: Navy, Teal and Yellow. All of them are present in the logo and are used for most of the graphics for digital and print materials. Additionally, Light Teal, Black and White are used when needed.



Navy

HEX: #0A004A
RGB: RGB (10, 0, 74)
CMYK: C100% M95% Y37% K48%



Teal

HEX: #21A8B0
RGB: RGB (33, 168, 176)
CMYK: C74% M9% Y33% K0%



Yellow

HEX: #FFDE00
RGB: RGB (255, 222, 0)
CMYK: C2% M9% Y91% K0%



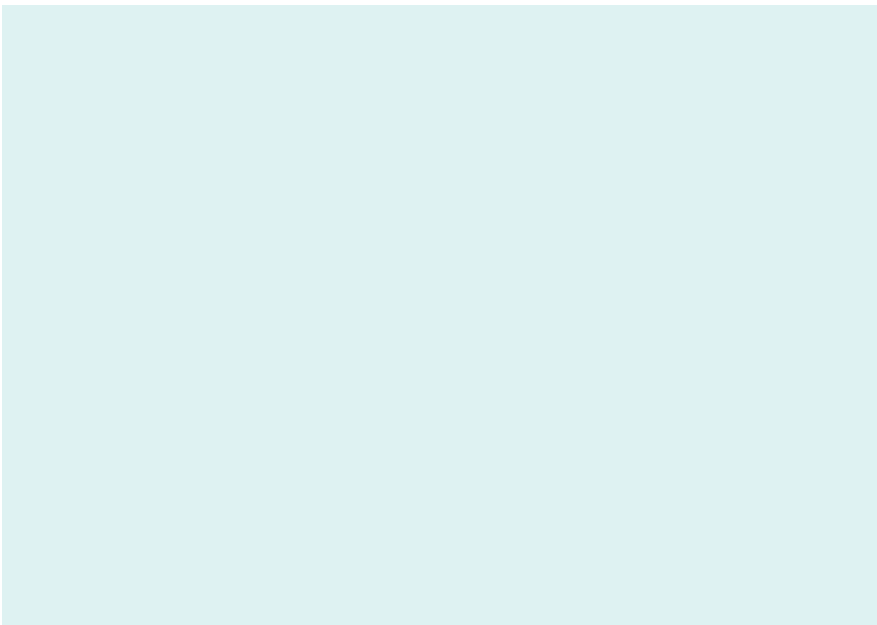
Light Navy

HEX: #3B336E
RGB: RGB (59, 51, 110)
CMYK: C92% M900% Y24% K12%



Muted Teal

HEX: #69BCC1
RGB: RGB (105, 188, 193)
CMYK: C59% M5% Y27% K0%



Light Teal

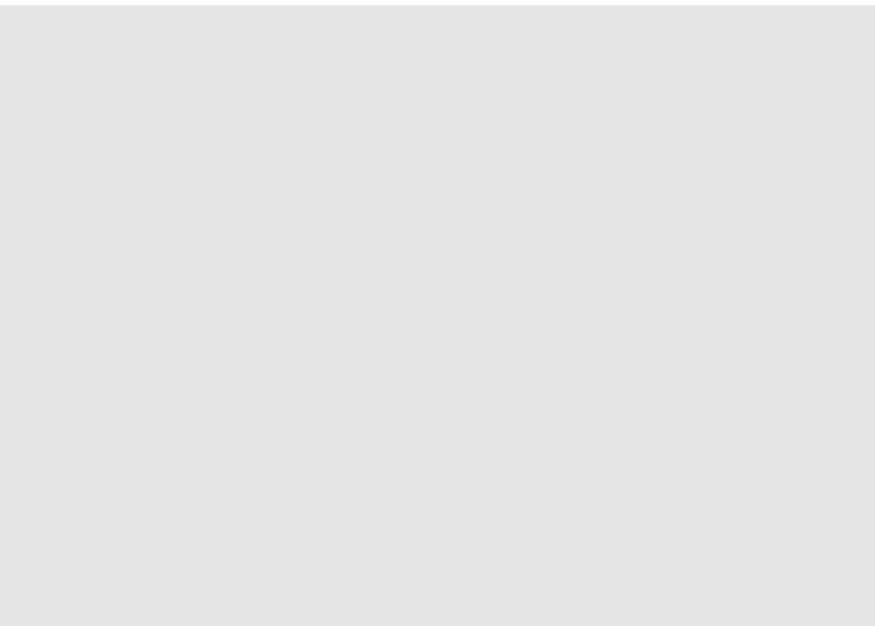
HEX: #DEF2F2
RGB: RGB (222, 242, 242)
CMYK: C15% M0% Y7% K0%

Secondary Color Palette

Monochrome Palette (RGB) is mainly used for any additional secondary elements on Aptly layouts such as: UI elements, dividers and other details within RGB color space that need to be monochrome.

Monochrome Palette (CMYK) is used for printed Aptly materials. Make sure you use the CMYK space while applying these colors to the materials.

Tertiary Colors are used to make print or digital materials more interesting.



Light Grey

HEX: #E6E6E6
RGB: RGB (230, 230, 230)
CMYK: CO% MO% YO% K10%



Grey

HEX: #CCCCCC
RGB: RGB (204, 204, 204)
CMYK: CO% MO% YO% K20%



Rich Black

HEX: #333333
RGB: RGB (51, 51, 51)
CMYK: CO% MO% YO% K80%



Red

HEX: #E84133
RGB: RGB (255, 73, 73)
CMYK: CO% M85% Y80% K0%



Orange

HEX: #EC6726
RGB: RGB (158, 98, 255)
CMYK: CO% M70% Y90% K0%

Color Gradient

The gradient in our brand identity transitions smoothly from Navy to Light Teal, symbolizing our values of innovation and dynamism. It should be used primarily in backgrounds, overlays, and interactive elements, maintaining a consistent direction and ratio.

Ensure high contrast when placing text over the gradient to preserve readability. Avoid altering the gradient colors, introducing new gradients, or using it in ways that diminish its impact or create visual clutter. Consistent use of this gradient enhances brand recognition and visual coherence across all media.

Use this tool to create it:
<https://cssgradient.io/>



Navy
#0A004A



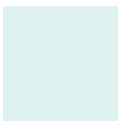
Light Navy
#3B336E



Teal
#21A8B0



Muted Teal
#69BCC1



Light Teal
#DEF2F2

Illustrations 4

People Illustration System

Aptly's characters are based on diversity and inclusivity.

Characters should be designed in multiple situations, going from an abstract approach to a more realistic one for more functional contexts.

Faces and hands have to be expressive, showing different emotions.

Shadows are a must in clothing, and they can be also included to show real light effects on the characters (such as the shadow that a person naturally has under the neck).



Animals Illustration System

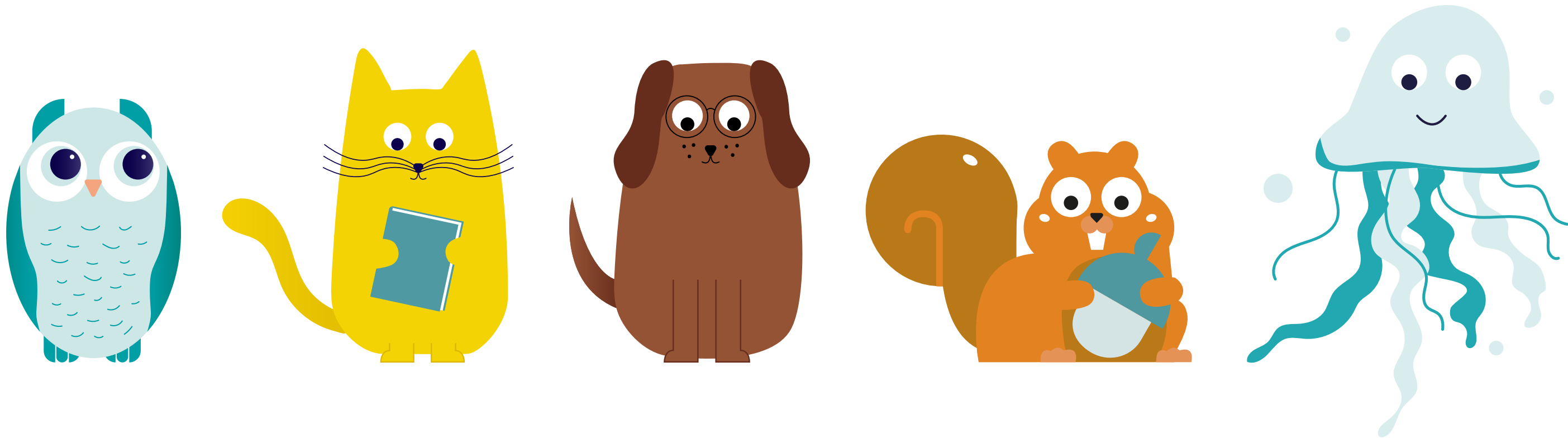
We’ve chosen some animals to represent fun scenes.

These animals should be consistent and they should be always on a scene with context.

Their bodys are always simple, flat and modern. We can use gradients to add depth to their bodies, such as in a tail or ears.

Animals can have human behaviors: they can be reading, studying, using a phone.

Their eyes are always big and expressive.



Illustrations

Color Palette

Apart from Aptly’s main and secondary color palettes, these hues have been added in order to make the illustrations more rich and complex in colors.

These colors are bright and engaging, yet resonate with a sense of calm and clarity. They embody the energy of innovation at the heart of our brand, while also providing a complementary backdrop that grounds the illustrations. Every shade has been carefully curated to ensure accessibility and comfort for the eyes, allowing our imagery to be as inclusive as it is impactful.

Through this chromatic harmony, we create a visual consistency that is instantly recognizable and distinctly Aptly.



Light Orange

HEX: #E08534
RGB: RGB (224, 133, 52)
CMYK: C0% M58% Y96% K0%



Light Red

HEX: #D15549
RGB: RGB (209, 85, 73)
CMYK: C3% M82% Y72% K0%



Green

HEX: #88B644
RGB: RGB (136, 182, 68)
CMYK: C58% M0% 100% K0%



Light Purple

HEX: #5C54D2
RGB: RGB (92, 84, 210)
CMYK: C79% M70% Y0% K0%



Pink

HEX: #ED9FE2
RGB: RGB (237, 159, 226)
CMYK: C14% M45% Y0% K0%



Dark Grey

HEX: #9B9B9A
RGB: RGB (155, 155, 154)
CMYK: C40% M30% Y32% K10%

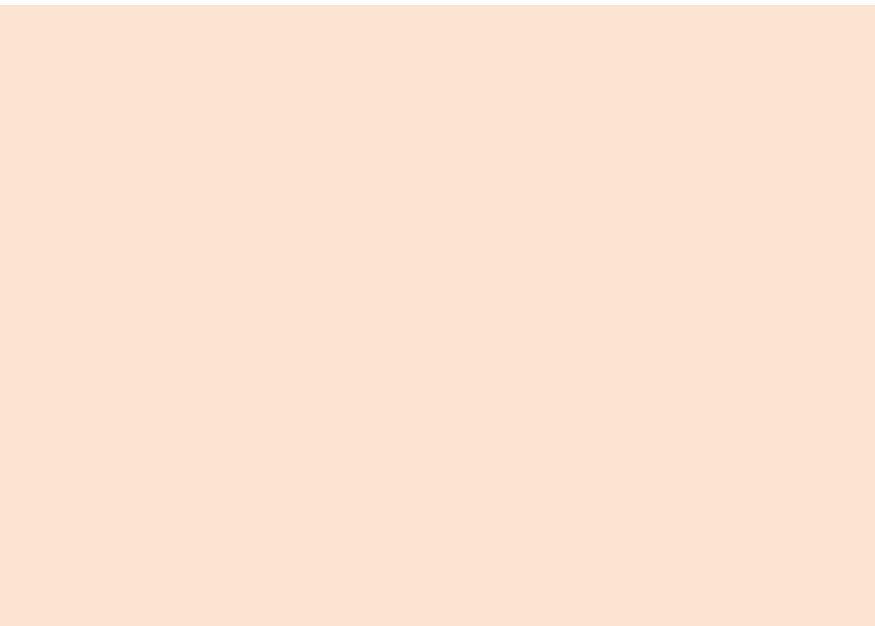
Illustrations

Skin Palette

We embrace a skin color palette that reflects the world's rich tapestry of human diversity. Our illustrations portray an inclusive community, offering a spectrum of skin tones that range from light to dark, each with its unique warmth and subtlety.

The colors are chosen to be harmonious yet distinct, ensuring that all individuals can see themselves represented within our visuals. By thoughtfully selecting shades that resonate with a global audience, we communicate our values of unity and respect for all.

This palette is a celebration of diversity, encouraging connections and conversations across cultures and communities, integral to the fabric of Aptly's identity.



Light Pink

HEX: #FDE4D2
RGB: RGB (253, 228, 210)
CMYK: C0% M13% Y18% K0%



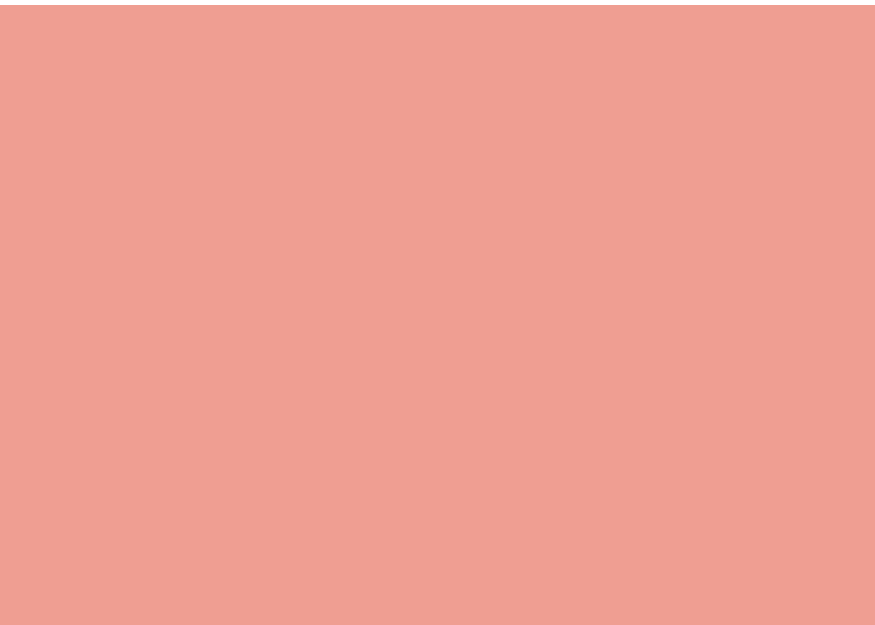
Light Orange

HEX: #FDCE96
RGB: RGB (253, 206, 150)
CMYK: C0% M23% Y45% K0%



Light Brown

HEX: #97503C
RGB: RGB (151, 80, 60)
CMYK: C28% M70% 72% K27%



Pink

HEX: #EF9E92
RGB: RGB (239, 158, 146)
CMYK: C2% M48% Y37% K0%



Orange

HEX: #FDAE7D
RGB: RGB (253, 174, 125)
CMYK: C0% M40% Y52% K0%



Brown

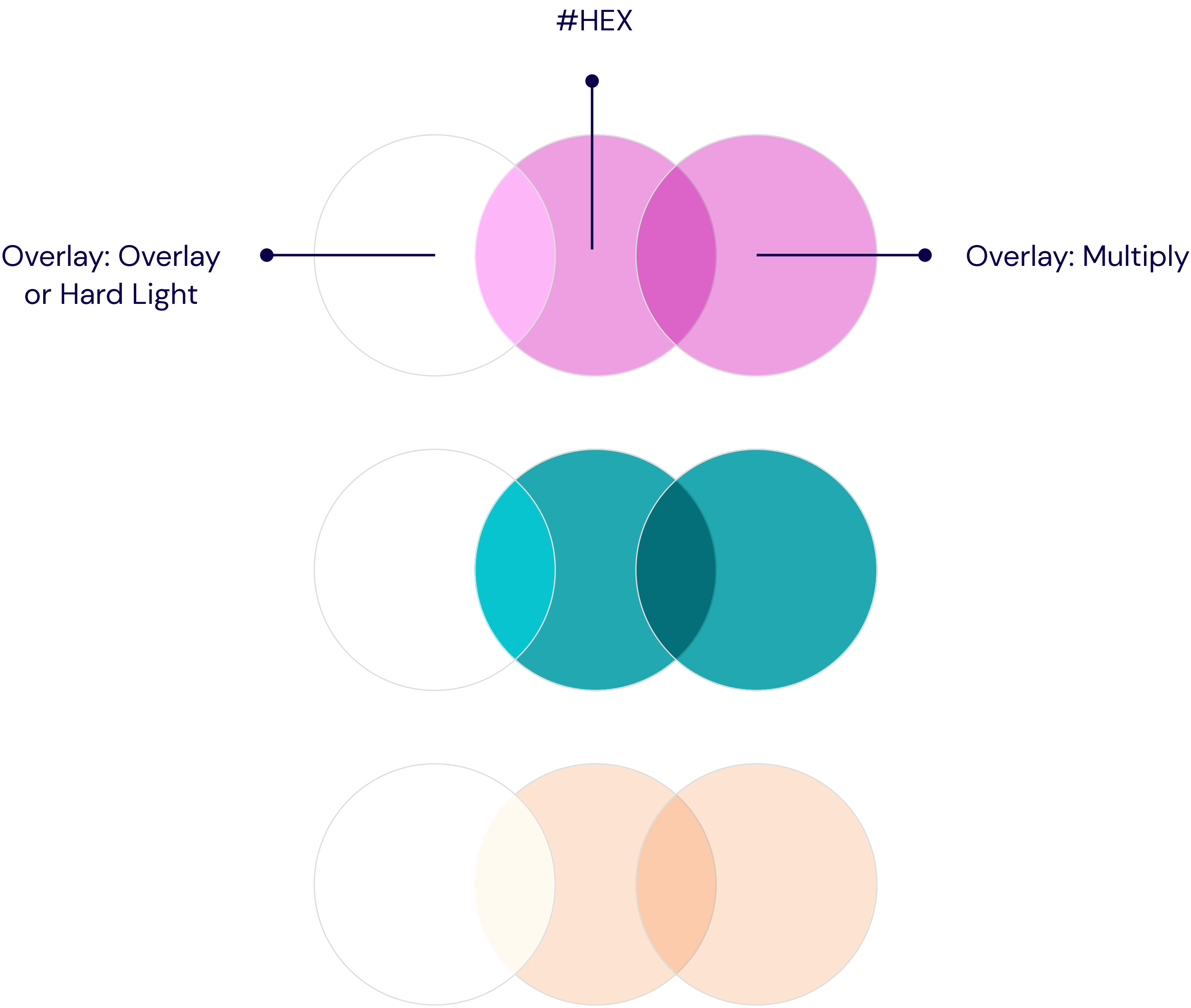
HEX: #7D524E
RGB: RGB (125, 82, 78)
CMYK: C35% M61% Y52% K40%

Illustrations

Shadows & Lights

Using overlays on a color can be a powerful technique for creating shadows and depth in design. Here are some rules to follow for effective use:

- 1. Choose the Right Overlay Mode: Select a mode that makes the color darker to create a realistic shadow effect.
- 2. Adjust Transparency: Use transparency or opacity settings to control the intensity of the shadow. Experiment with different levels of transparency to achieve the desired depth without overpowering the design.
- 3. Layering and Blending: Apply overlays on separate layers and use blending modes such as Multiply or Overlay to blend the shadow with the base color. This technique helps create a seamless transition between the two colors.



Examples

A) Elements can go out from a frame. Body sizing must be proportional.

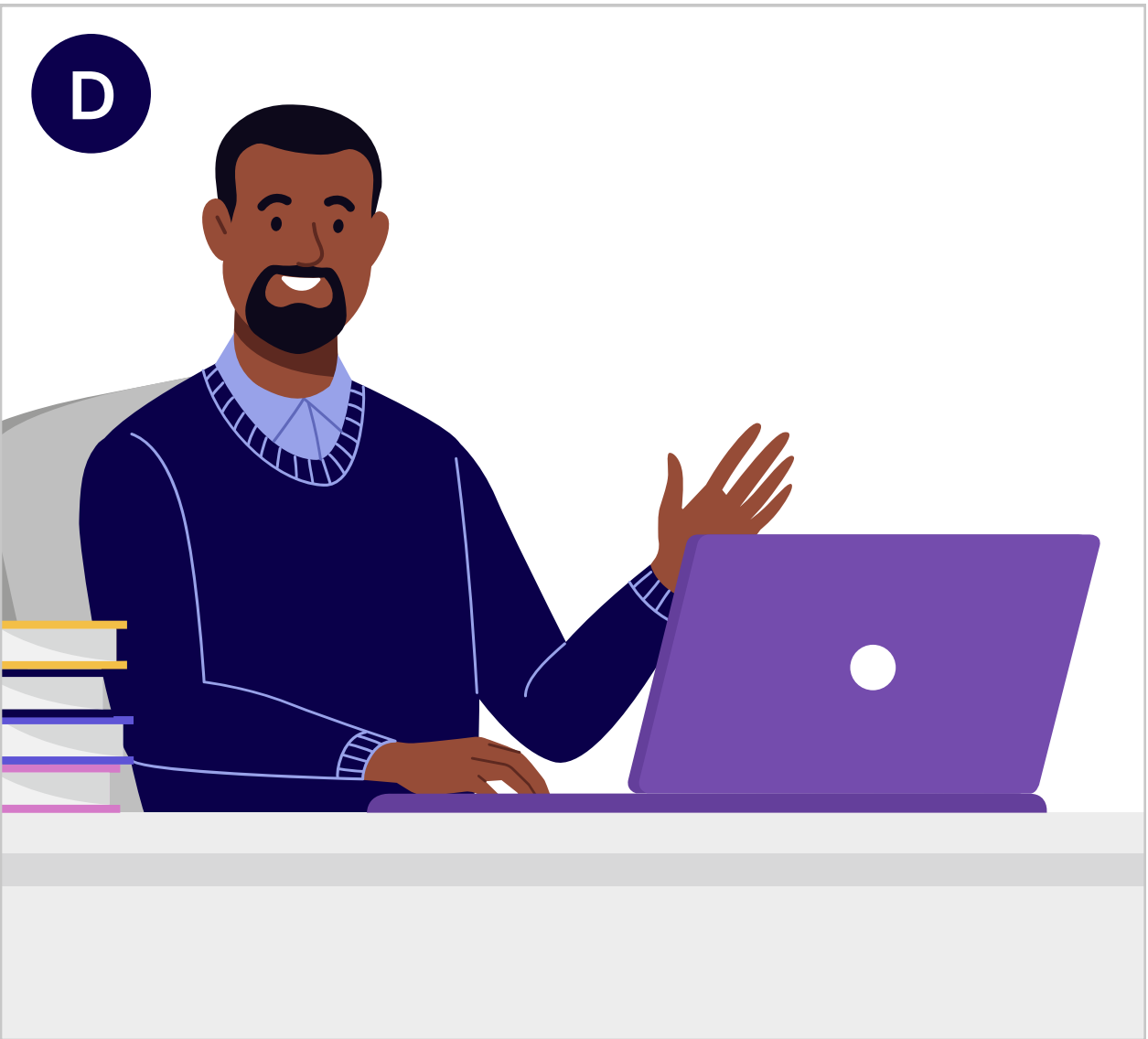
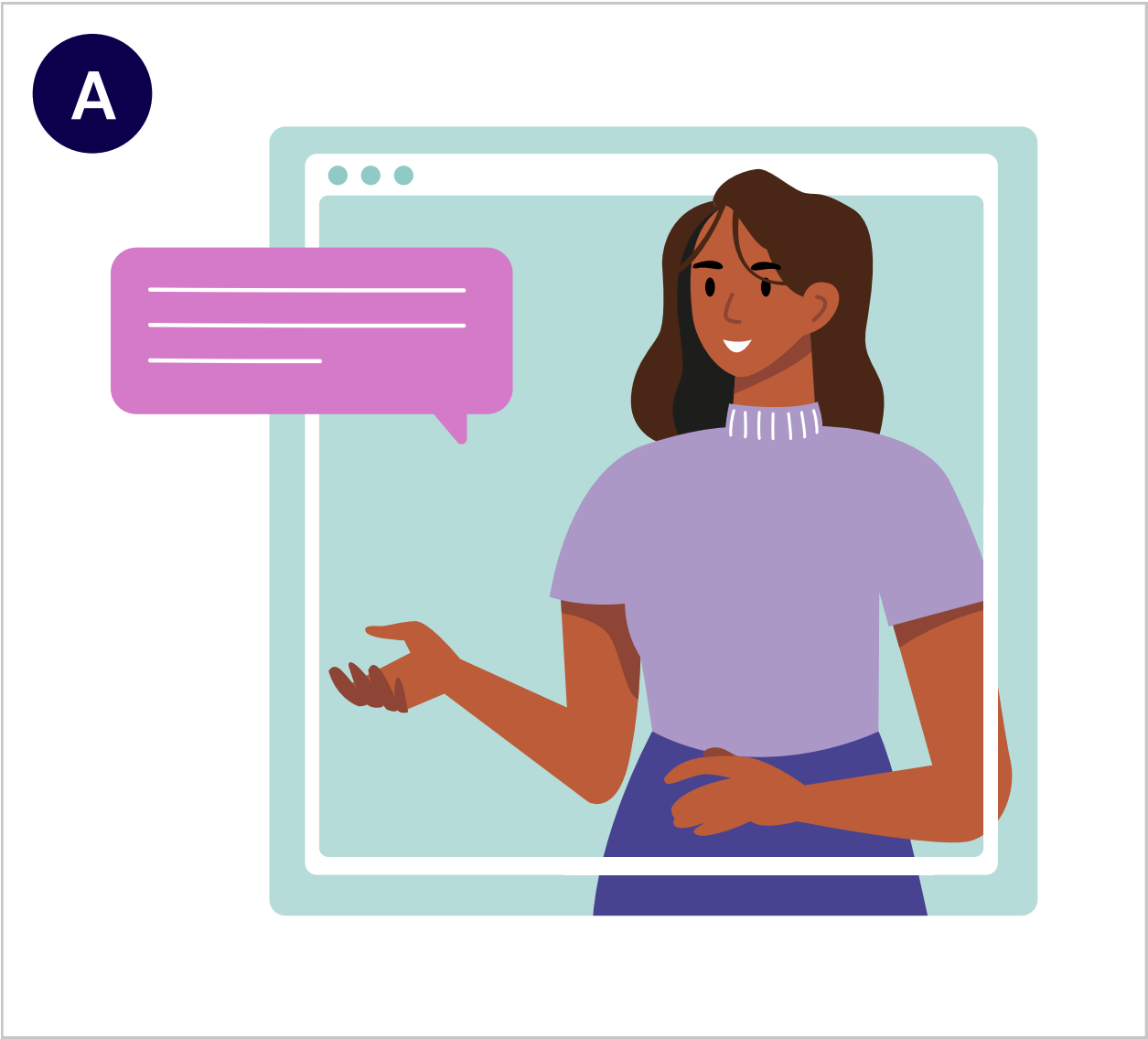
B) Make sure illustrations are inclusive and diverse.

C) Elements need to have organic and handdrawn expressions. Secondary elements can be in grey, not full colored.

D) If the color you're using is too dark, you can use a lighter color instead of shadowing.

**Note for all: Illustrations must have teal, purple and navy on them. But you can add any extra color you think it will match.*

**Try not exceed from 6 or 7 colors per illustration.*



Details Matter

Following these guidelines will ensure effective branding communication that resonates with your audience. Embracing a modern and simplistic flat design style with vibrant yet cohesive colors will convey professionalism and visual harmony.

Diverse and inclusive character designs, along with consistent style, will enhance relatability and readability.

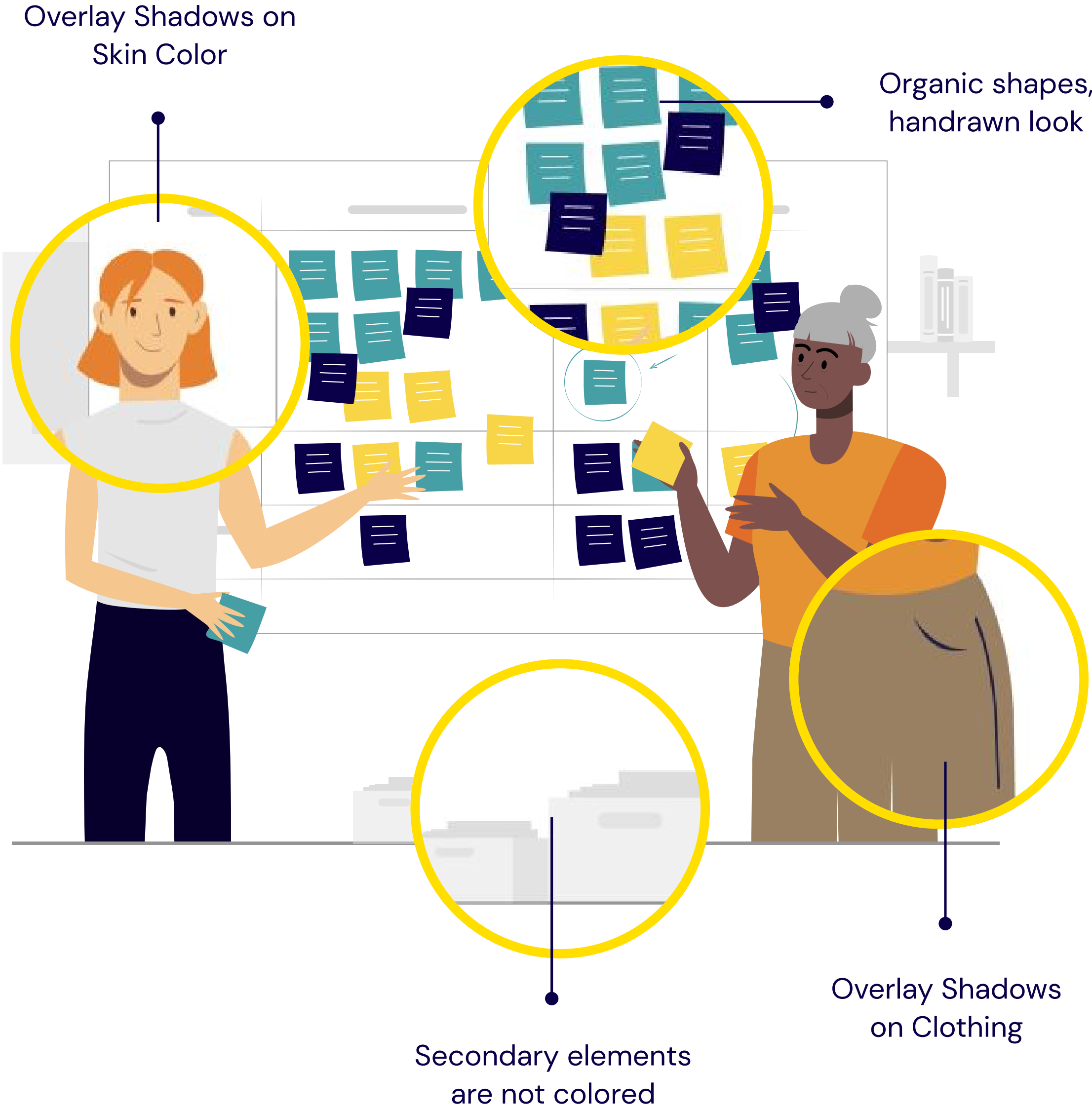


Illustration Guidelines

Style and Tone

- Use flat design with a modern, clean, and simplistic approach.
- Illustrations should be friendly and approachable, with a professional tone.

Composition

- Layouts should be balanced and clean, avoiding clutter.
- Focus on clear visual storytelling with a central point of interest.

Accessibility

- Ensure high contrast for readability and accessibility.
- Consider color blindness and other visual impairments in your designs.

Color Palette

- Employ a vibrant, yet cohesive color scheme that reflects the company’s branding.
- Use bold and saturated colors for primary elements and softer tones for backgrounds.

Typography

- Use typography that complements the illustration style – clean, legible, and friendly.
- Ensure text is integrated seamlessly with images.

Scalability

- Illustrations should be scalable and visible at various sizes.
- Avoid intricate details that can be lost in smaller sizes.

Character Design

- Characters should be diverse, inclusive, and represent a variety of roles, ages, and backgrounds.
- The design of characters should be consistent with rounded shapes and simplified features.

Iconography

- Icons should be simple and easily recognizable, matching the style of the illustrations.
- Use consistent stroke weights and avoid over-detailing.

Emotional Tone

- Illustrations should evoke the desired emotional response, whether it’s excitement, trust, or curiosity.
- Use facial expressions and body language in characters to convey emotions.

Branding Elements

- Incorporate the company’s logo subtly into the illustrations.
- Use branding elements consistently across all illustrations.

Scenes and Environments

- Create environments that are relevant to the content, such as office settings for business or trees and benches for outdoor scenes.
- Backgrounds should not distract from the main subjects but should complement the overall message.

Usage Across Platforms

- Illustrations should work well across different mediums – digital, print, social media, etc.
- Adapt layouts and compositions accordingly.

Photography 5

Imagery Selection

For digital usage imagery can be found on Adobe, a great source with high-quality imagery which are selected by the website curators.

Select imagery that showcases the content: people, lifestyle, digital, devices and everything that explains Aptly processes in a literal way.

Try to select minimalistic pictures instead of busy. The fewer elements an image includes, the more focus it brings to a context.

We are about diversity (age, race, gender, sexuality) and want to reflect this on our imagery.

We want human-driven photos.

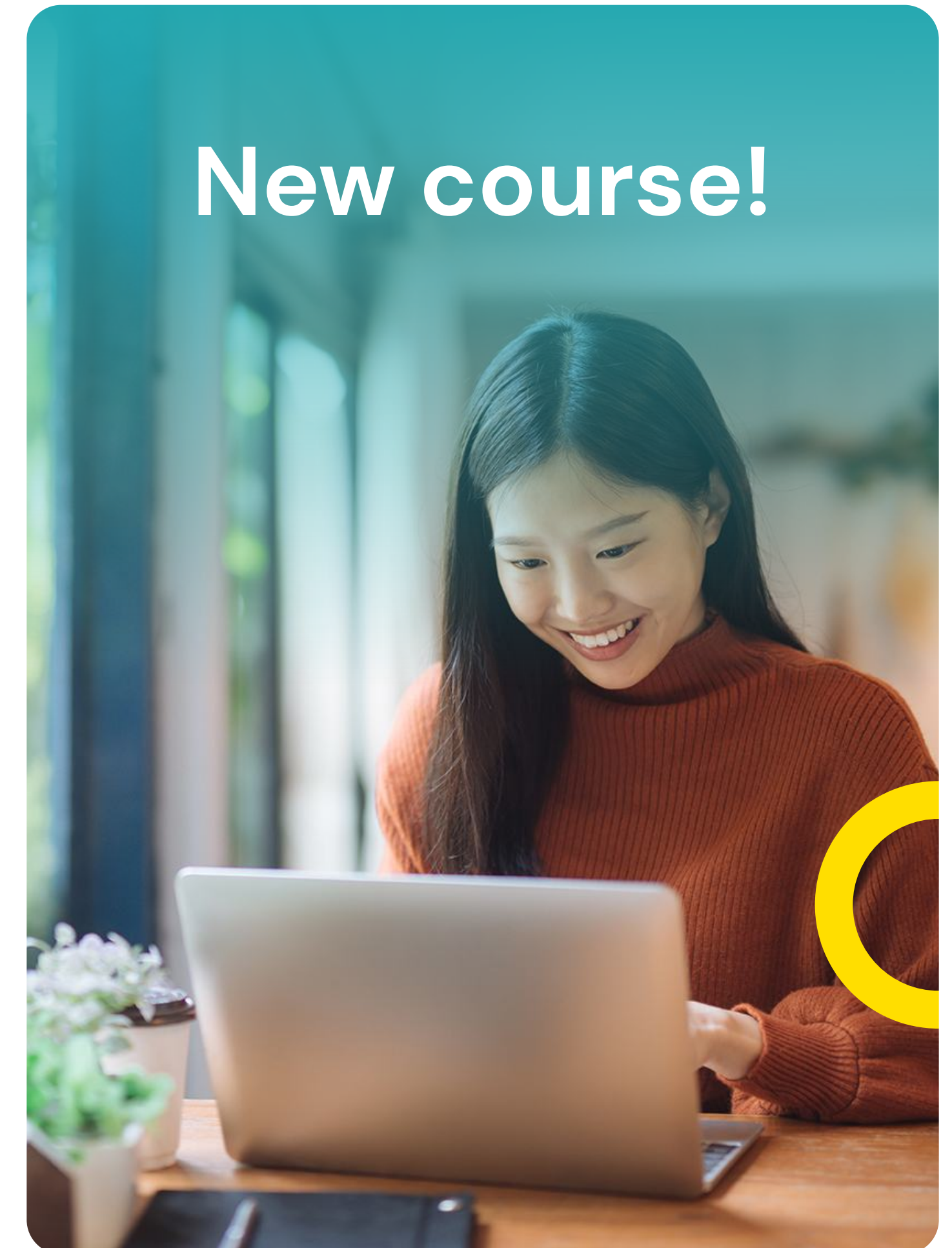
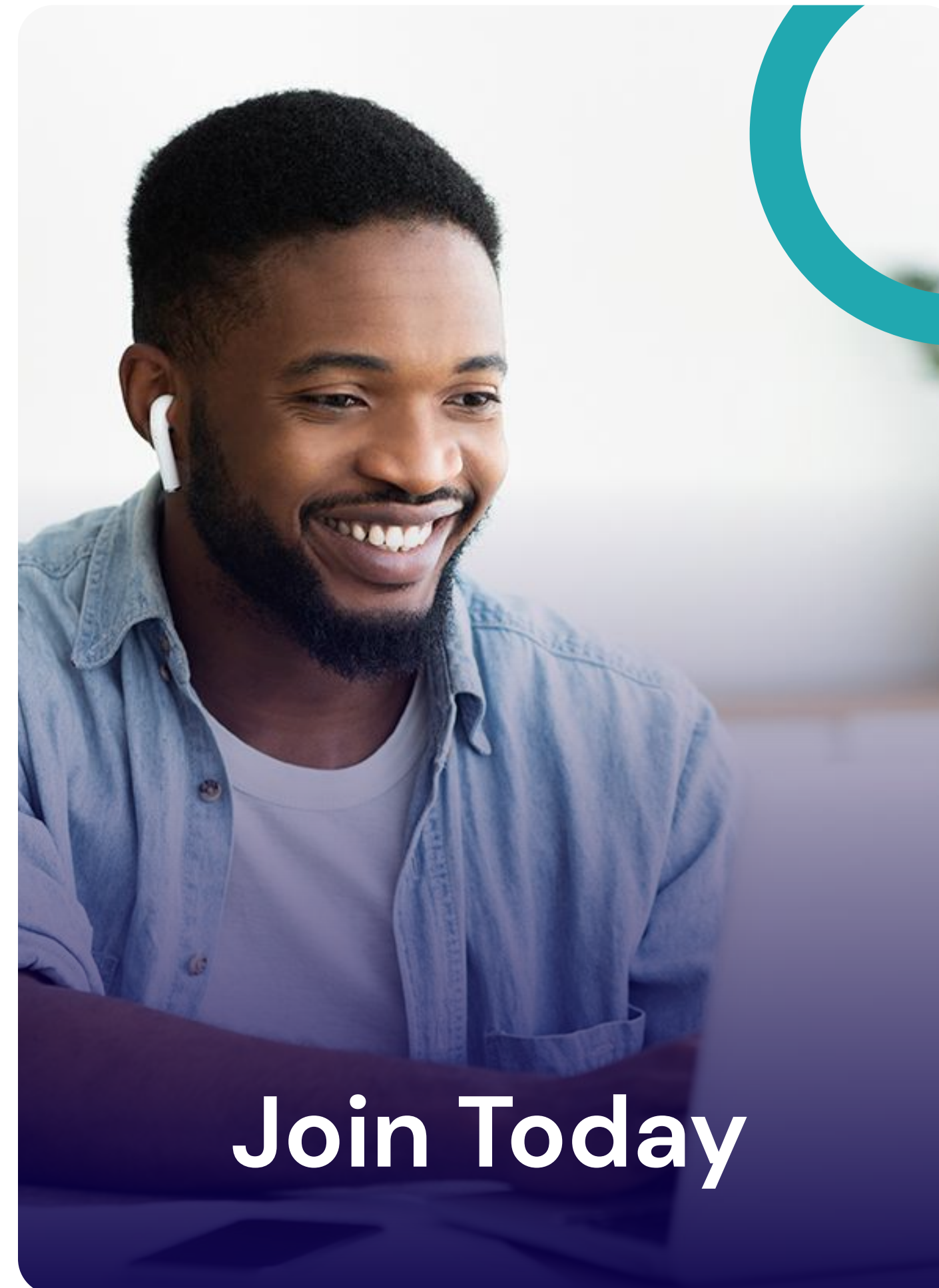
Photos need to have rounded corners on video.



Imagery & Gradients

When adding text on top of an image, always apply a dark gradient overlay to ensure that the text remains readable and stands out clearly. This technique should be used sparingly, primarily when it is necessary to make the text accessible on the image.

All ornamental graphics must be always designed using the main color palette.



Graphics 6

Icons

Aptly Icon System follows the next rules:

- 1. Use outlines icons
- 2. Use rounded corners where possible
- 3. Make sure your icon fits in a square format
- 4. Make sure you do not have many details

[You can find the library here.](#)



Circles

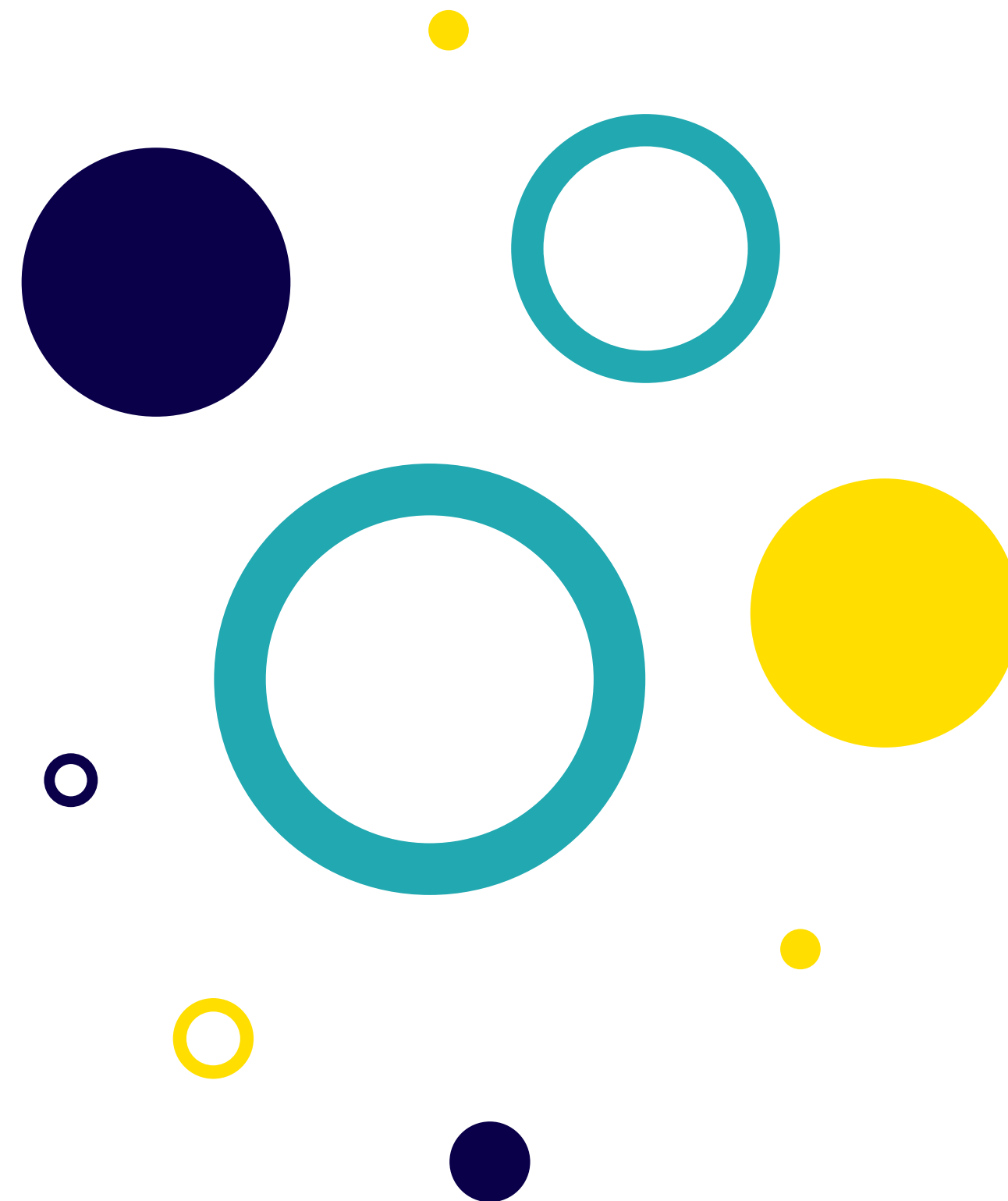
When using circles with fill and circles with just a stroke as part of a branding element, it's important to follow certain rules to maintain consistency and visual appeal.

Use circles with fill and circles with stroke to create contrast and hierarchy within your design. For example, you can use filled circles for main elements or focal points, while using stroked circles for secondary or supporting elements.

Coordinate the colors of filled circles and strokes to create a cohesive color scheme. Consider using complementary or analogous colors to enhance visual impact while maintaining harmony.

All ornamental graphics must be always designed using the main color palette.

[You can find the Google Slides template here.](#)
[You can find the Figma template here.](#)



Social

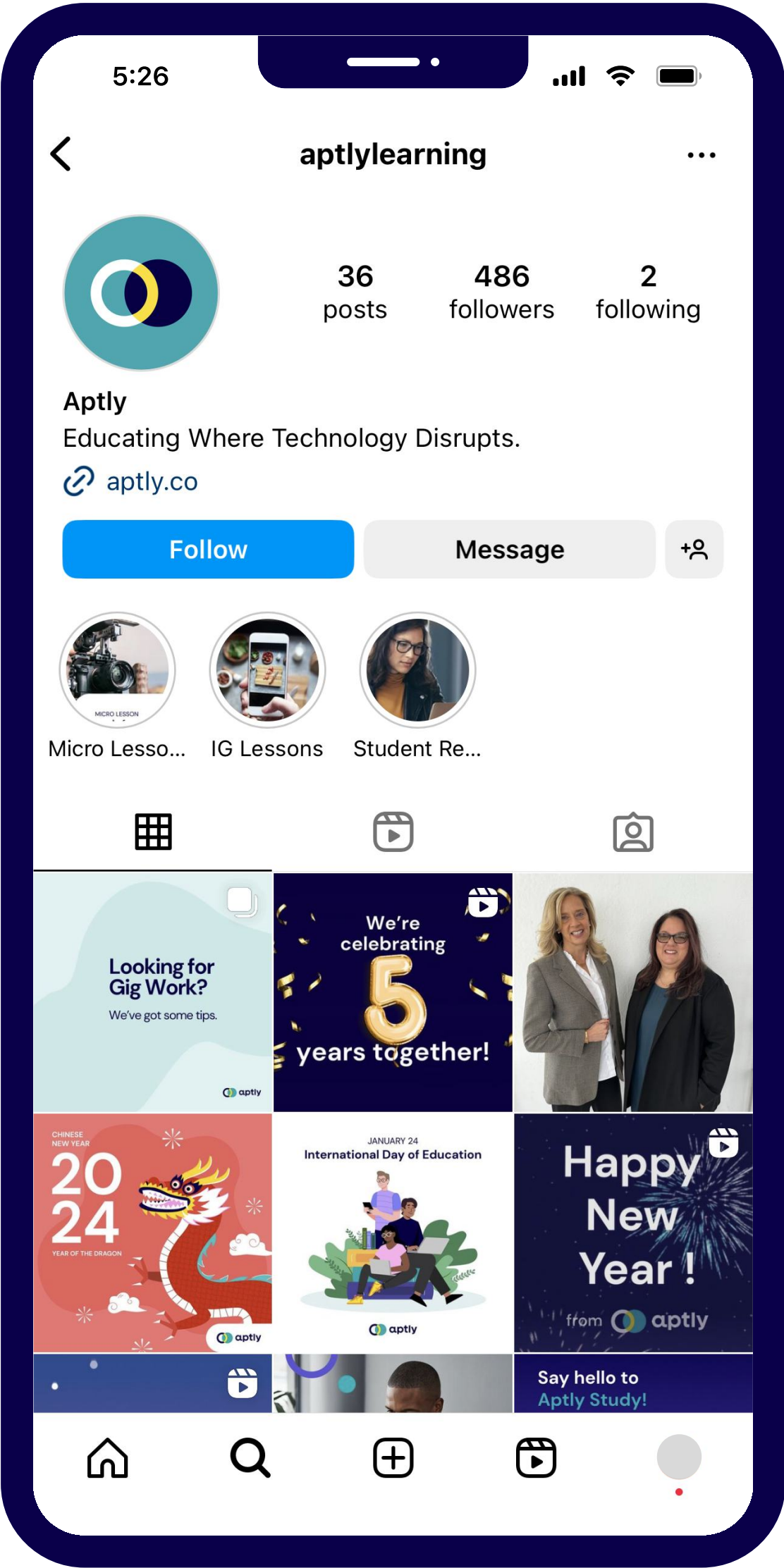
7

Instagram

Aptly's Instagram presence is a blend of inspiration, education, and community engagement. The feed is a visual storyboard that encapsulates the commitment to learning and connection, featuring rich, engaging colors and inclusive illustrations.

Through thoughtfully crafted content the aim is to not only inform but also empower the followers. Instagram is more than a platform; it's a classroom without walls, and a window into the world of Aptly.

Some posts may include the celebration of Aptly's milestones, announcement of new courses, celebration of different holidays or festive days, insightful tips about each course content.





aptlylearning

...



New Course!

Introduction to Accessibility and Universal Design





aptlylearning

...

JANUARY 24

International Day of Education







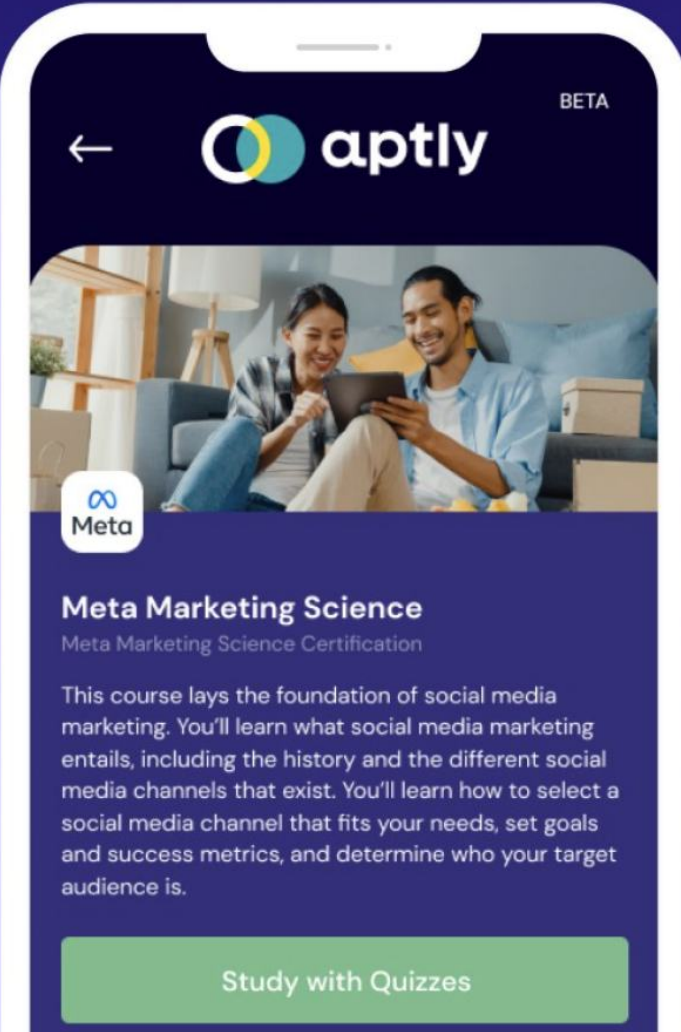


aptlylearning

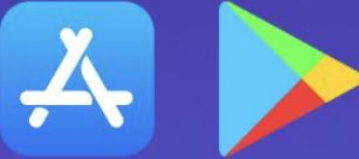
...

Say hello to Aptly Study!

Jump in and practice for your cert exam.



GET IT ON

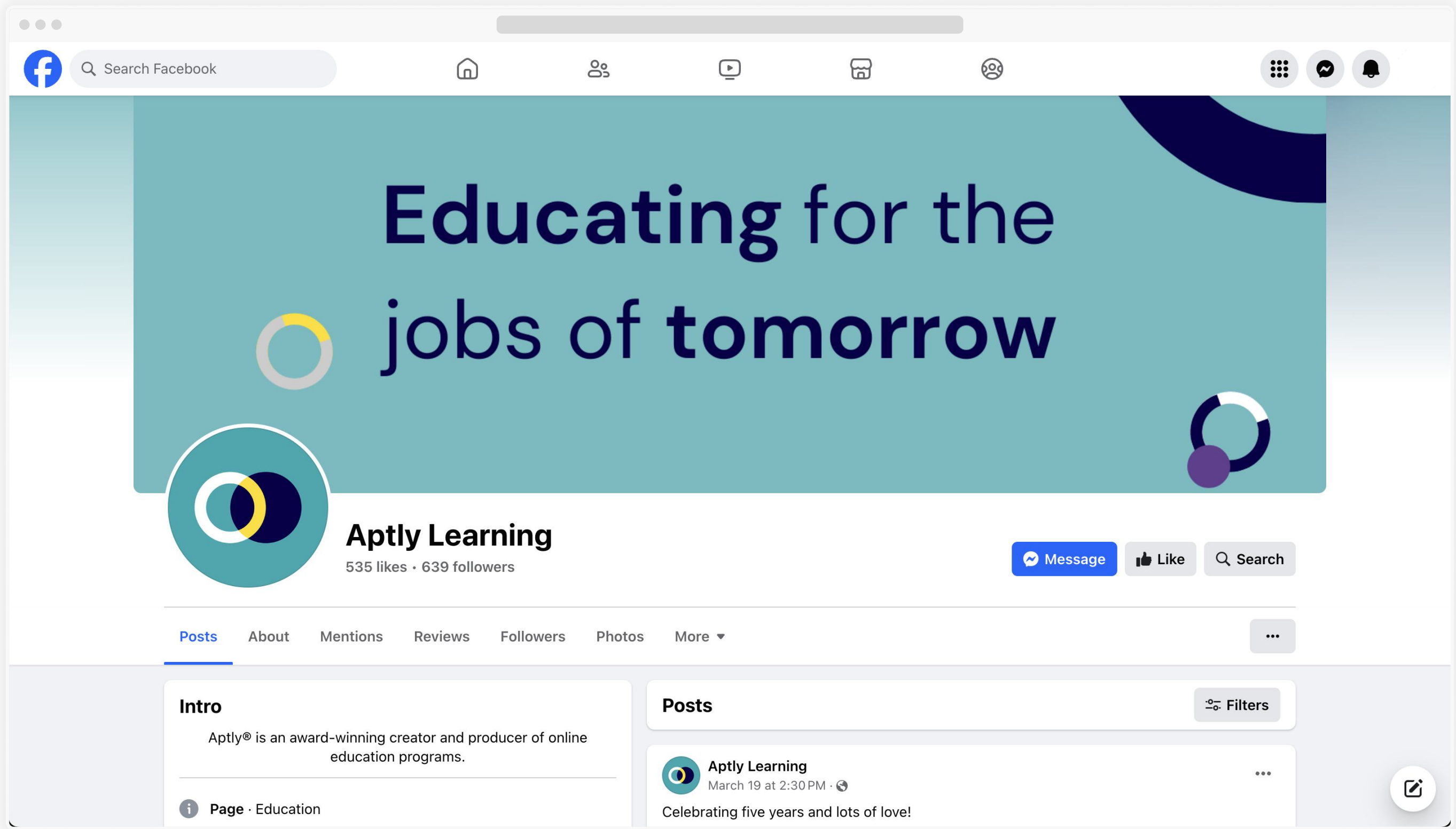




Facebook

Aptly's Facebook page offers a dynamic mix of inspiration, education, and community interaction.

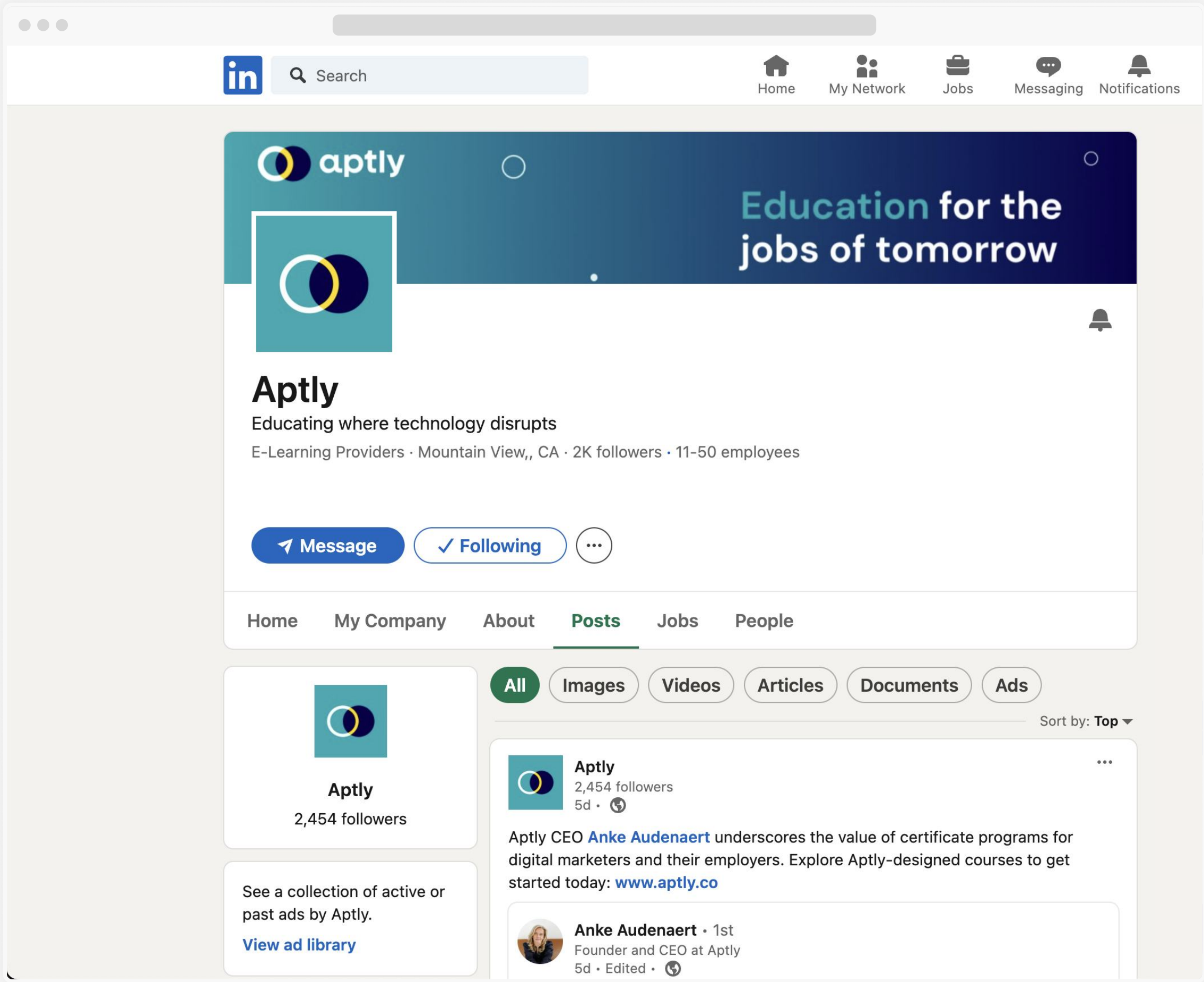
It maintains the same guidelines as the Instagram page, where the content informs and empowers the followers, celebrating milestones, sharing course updates, and providing insightful tips.



LinkedIn

Aptly's LinkedIn page is a hub of professional engagement, connecting with employees, businesses, as well as the founders and leaders.

A variety of insightful blog posts and industry insights are shared, fostering dialogue and collaboration within the network. From thought leadership pieces to updates on company initiatives, Aptly's LinkedIn presence is a platform for meaningful connections and knowledge sharing.

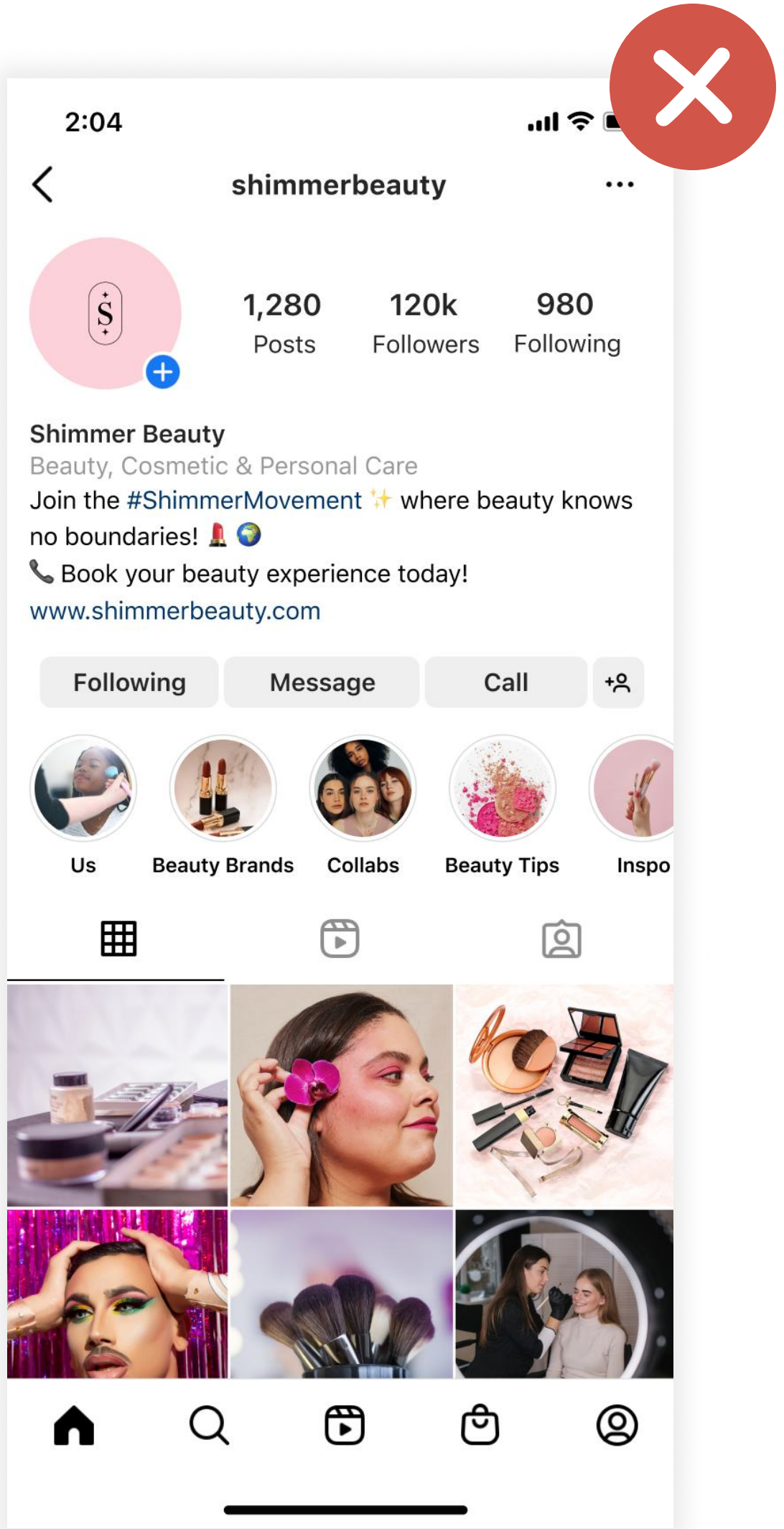
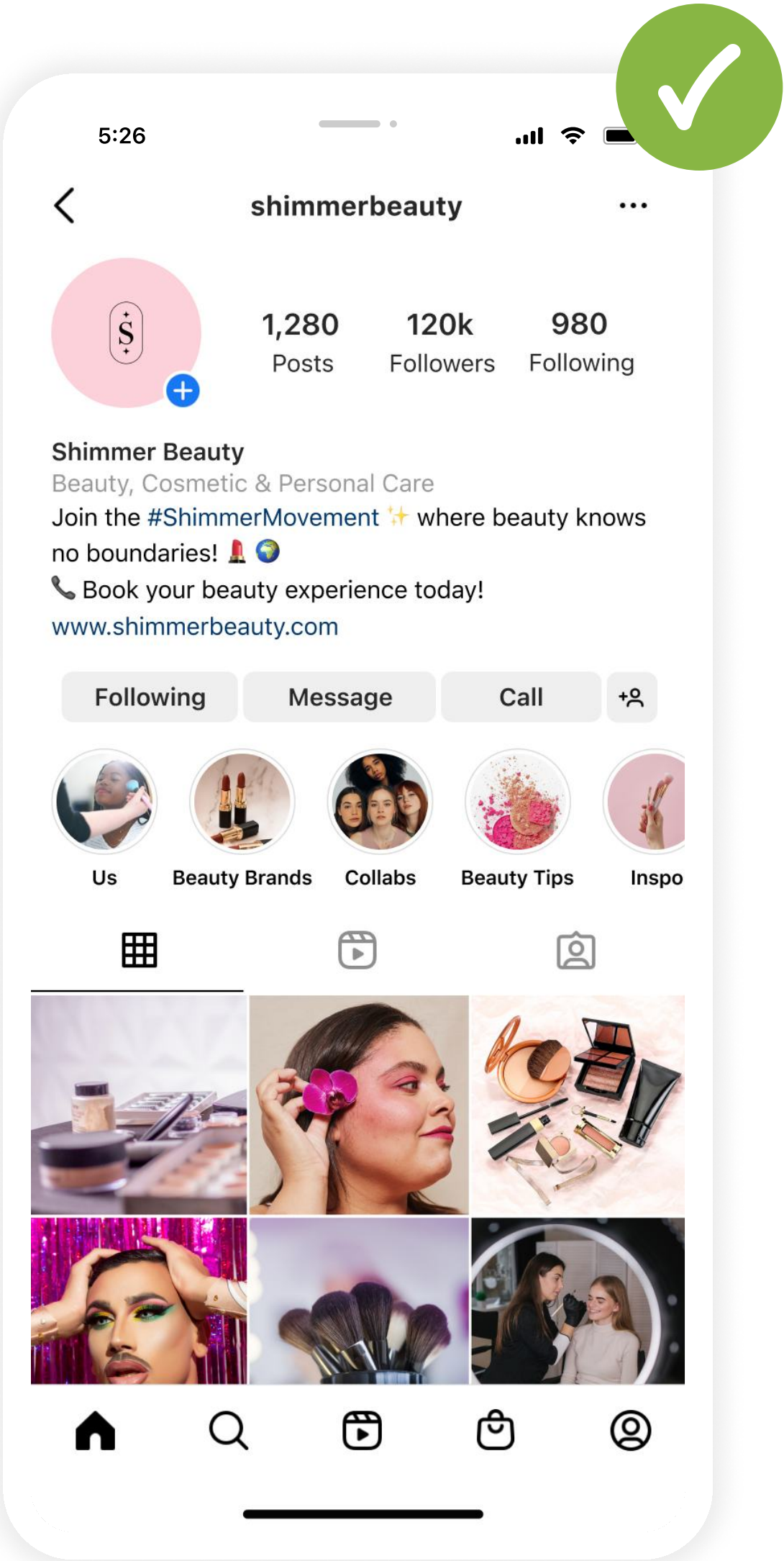


UI Rules 8

Phone UI

All Phone UIs must have a Phone frame.

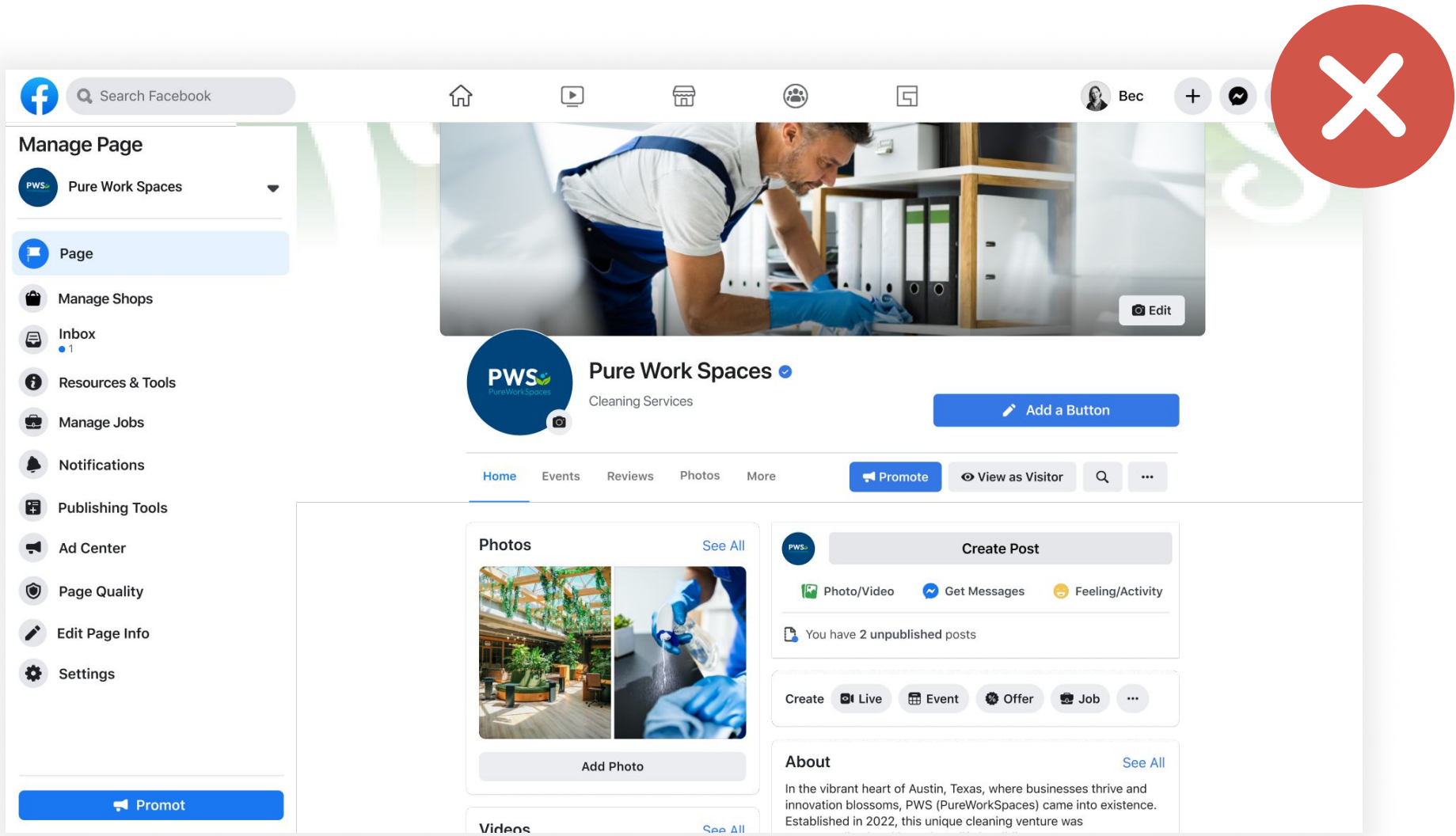
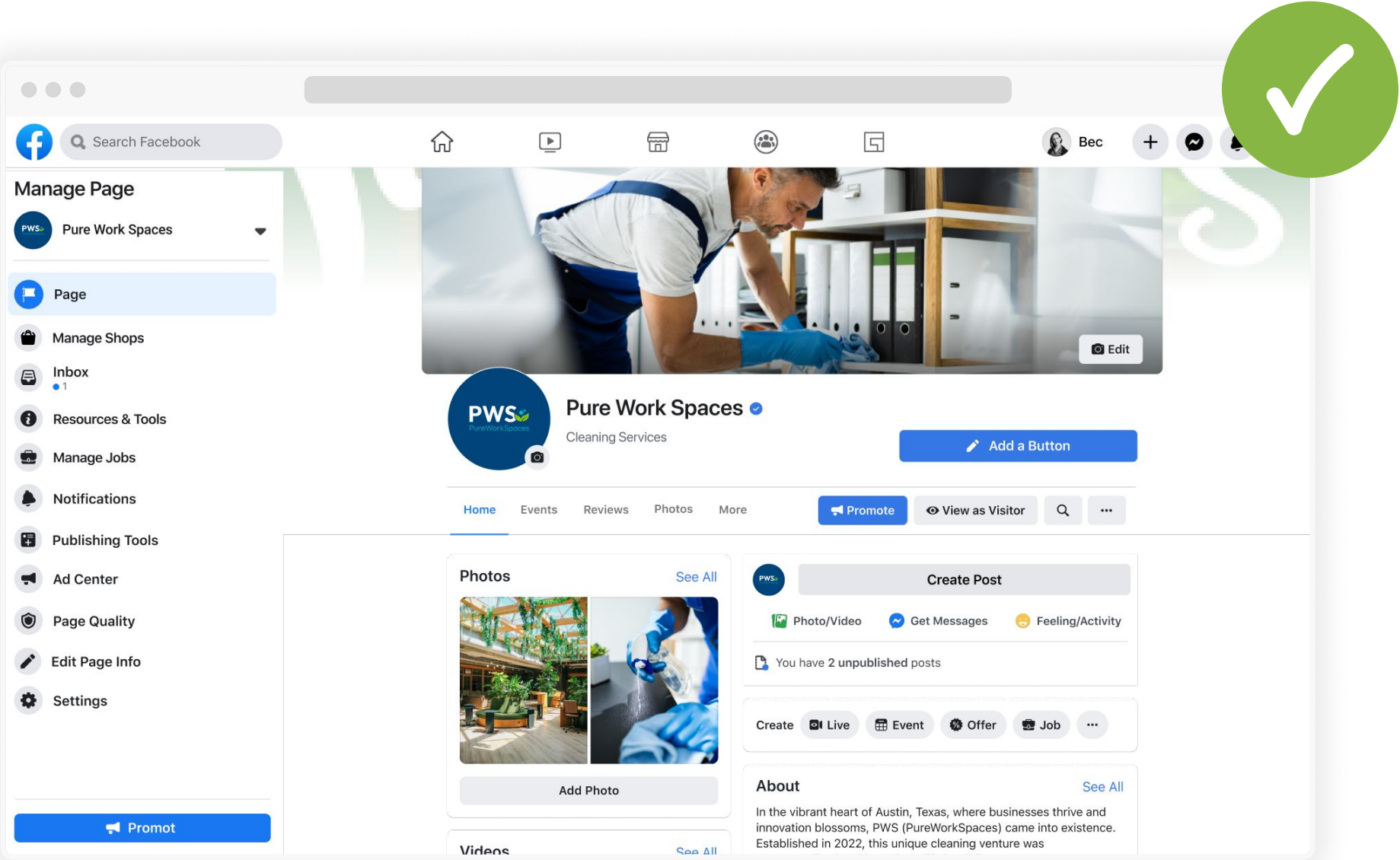
Phone frames need to be placed on every storyboard so the Production Team know how the final video should look.



Desktop UI

All Desktop UIs must have a Desktop frame.

Desktop frames need to be placed on every storyboard so the Production Team know how the final video should look.

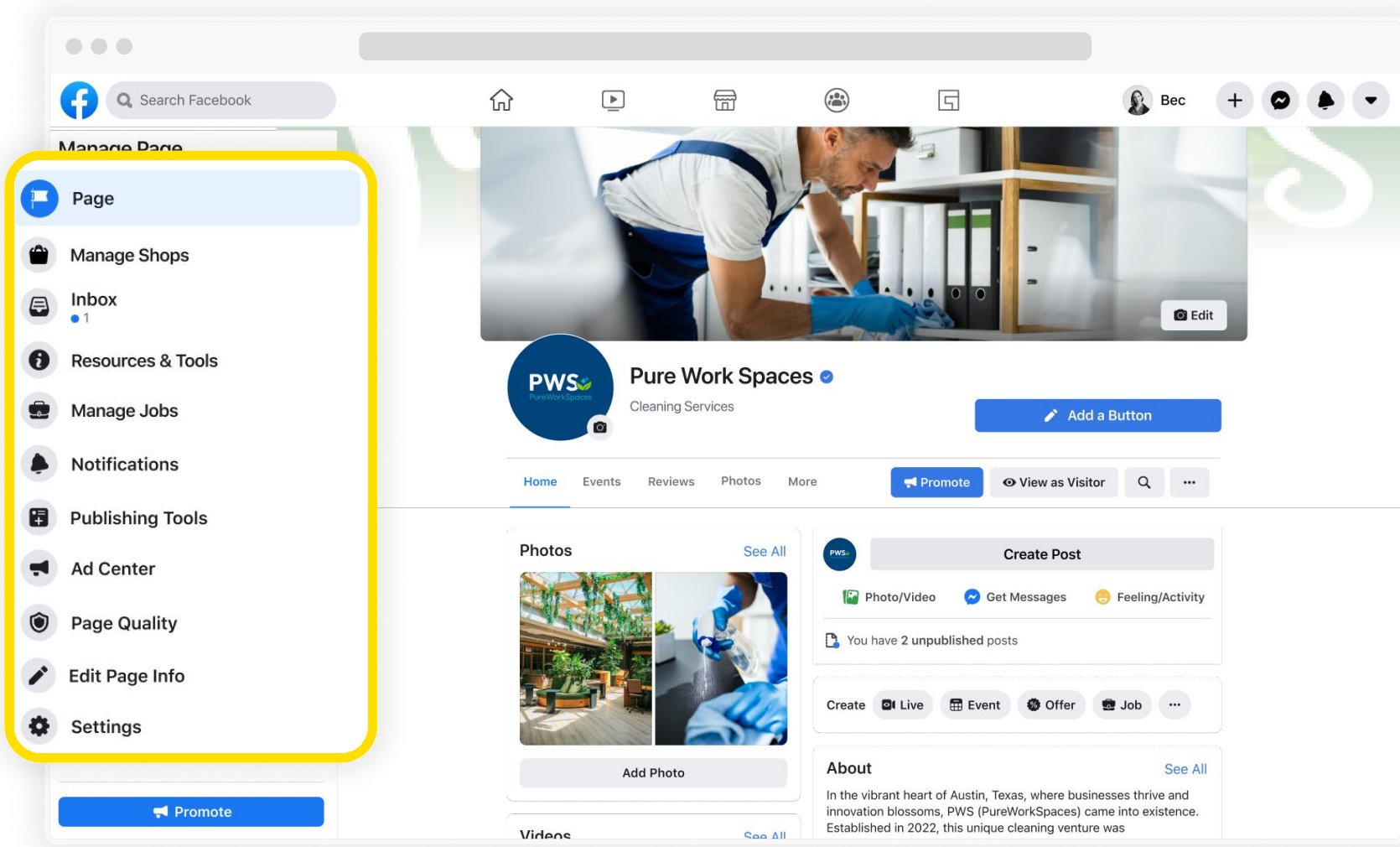
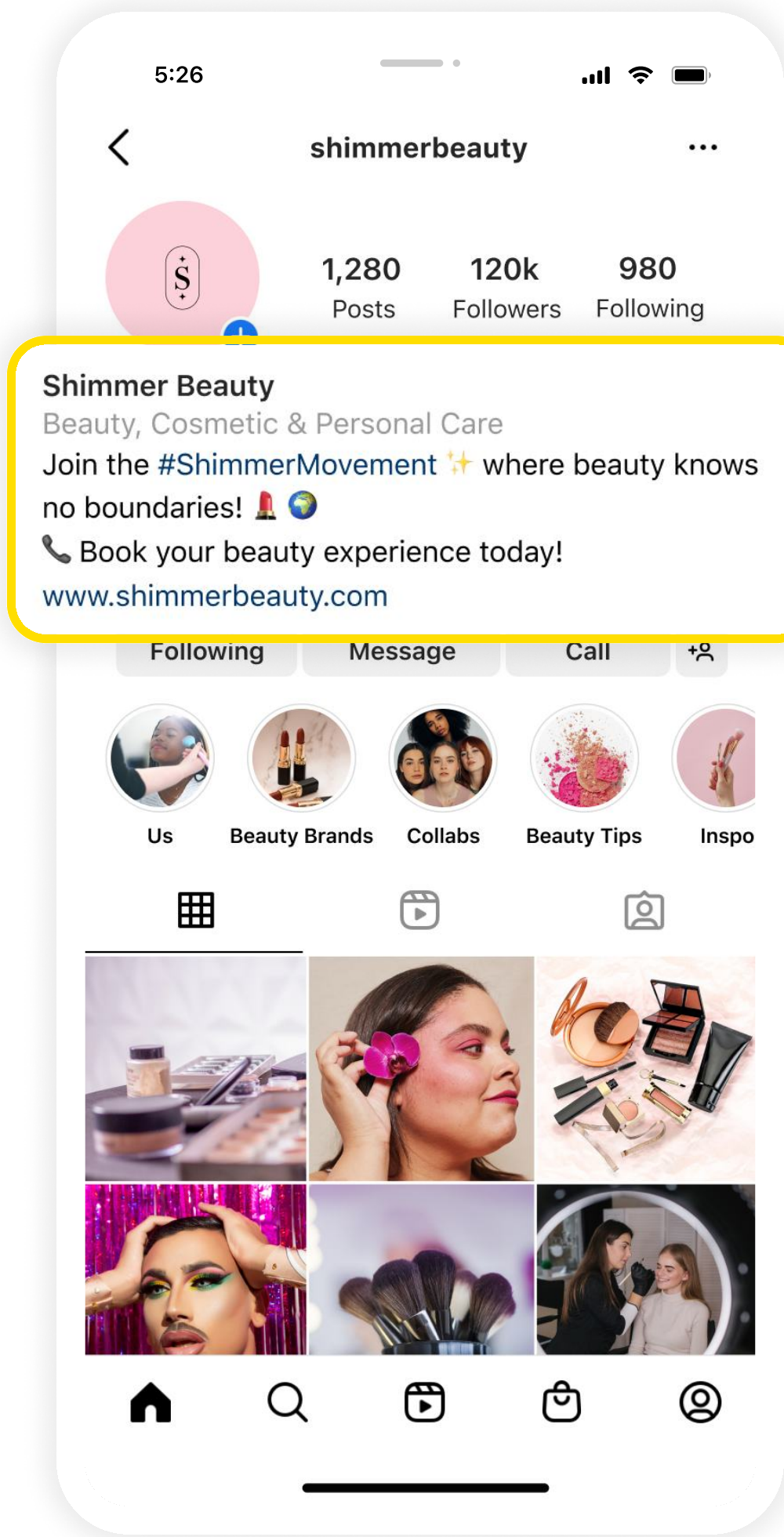


Highlights

All highlights/callouts must have the same format.

- Zoom in the part of the image desired for the highlight
- Add a rounded corner border in Aptly Yellow color (#FFDE00) with a border weight of 8-12px

The final look of this in each video will be done by the Production Team, but the Design Team must delimitate the highlight area in the storyboard.



Print

9

Stickers

Aptly Stickers serve as a component of the brand's print materials. When crafting any printed materials, it's essential to ensure that the logo is displayed and easily discernible. To prevent any unintended cropping or distortion of the logo, it's important to include sufficient white space around it.

Make sure you're working within a CMYK color space to maintain consistency and accuracy in color reproduction throughout the printing process.



Zip Up Hoodie

The Aptly-branded zip-up hoodies are also part of the merchandise lineup. It's crucial to ensure that the brand identity is accurately represented.

All merch is usually ordered from CustomInk, so any particular guidelines regarding logo size, placement, and color should be specified. This ensures consistency across all our branded merchandise.

Communicating the brand's color palette accurately is vital. CustomInk typically offers a range of color options for the hoodies, so it's essential to select hues that align well with Aptly's brand identity.

It's advisable to review digital proofs provided by CustomInk carefully. This allows to confirm that the placement, size, and color of our logo meet the expectations before finalizing the order.



Water Bottle

Aptly-branded water bottles are a staple in the merchandise lineup.

When ordering from CustomInk, ensure the logo is accurately represented in terms of size, placement, and color.

Review digital proofs to confirm alignment with the brand guidelines. By maintaining consistency across merchandise, we reinforce Aptly's brand identity effectively.





2024